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📍 Novi Sad, Serbia

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Python with PyTorch and TensorFlow
- Microsoft Azure Cloud
- MySQL and PostgreSQL
- PowerBI
- Git

CONCEPTUAL SKILLS

- Problem solving and critical thinking
- Machine learning and deep learning
- Data analysis
- Natural language processing and image processing
- Optimization
- Statistics

LANGUAGES

- Serbian | C2
- English | C1
- Portuguese | B2

STEVO RACKOVIĆ

·Data Scientist·

·Machine Learning Expert·

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Engineer

2025 – present

Sixsentix | Novi Sad

- Research and development with applications of Natural Language Processing techniques and Large Language Models for integrated software testing
- Implementation of ML Ops best practices with the drive for improving and monitoring the models
- ML Ops, Python, LangChain, Azure, Git

Data Scientist

2023 – 2025

Vega IT | Novi Sad

- Research and development with applications of Large Language Models in InsurTech
- Developing an agentic pipeline for knowledge extraction from documents

Researcher

2019 – 2023

Institute for Systems and Robotics | Lisbon

- Research on task offloading in networks of machines
- Developing deep reinforcement learning agents in PyTorch
- Research in distributed optimization and machine learning models with applications in the animation industry

Researcher

2018 – 2019

Faculty of Sciences | Novi Sad

- Developing models for distributed implementation of the common machine learning algorithms

Intern

2018

BioSense Institute | Novi Sad

- Developing a classifier to accurately recognize the cultures planted in specific fields using satellite images

EDUCATION

PhD in Statistics and Stochastic Processes

2019 – 2025

Instituto Superior Tecnico | Lisbon

- The curriculum covers machine learning, optimization, and statistics with a high demand for both theoretical and practical skills
- Thesis: *“Distributed optimization of bio-kinetic models based on large 4D sequences”*
- Solving large-scale optimization problems in the facial animation, with the focus on a distributed optimization setting for reducing computational costs

MSc in Applied Mathematics – Data Science

2016 – 2018

Faculty of Sciences | Novi Sad

BSc in Applied Mathematics – Mathematics of Finance

2013 – 2016

Faculty of Sciences | Novi Sad

PUBLICATIONS

- *“Clustering of the Blendshape Facial Model”*,
S. Rackovic, C. Soares, D. Jakovetic, Z. Desnica, R. Ljubobratovic,
2021, 29th European Signal Processing Conference (EUSIPCO)
- *“A Hybrid Compartmental Model with a Case Study of COVID-19 in Great Britain and Israel”*,
G. Malaspina, S. Rackovic, F. Valdeira,
2023, Journal of Mathematics in Industry
- *“Distributed Solution of the Blendshape Rig Inversion Problem”*,
S. Rackovic, C. Soares, D. Jakovetic,
2023, SIGGRAPH Asia 2023 Technical Communications
- *“A Majorization–Minimization–Based Method for Nonconvex Inverse Rig Problems in Facial Animation: Algorithm Derivation”*,
S. Rackovic, C. Soares, D. Jakovetic, Z. Desnica,
2023, Optimization Letters
- *“Refined Inverse Rigging: A Balanced Approach to High-fidelity Blendshape Animation”*,
S. Rackovic, D. Jakovetic, C. Soares,
2024, SIGGRAPH Asia 2024 Conference Papers
- *“PeersimGym: An Environment for Solving the Task Offloading Problem with Reinforcement Learning”*,
F. Metelo, C. Soares, S. Rackovic, P. A. Costa,
2024, Joint European Conference on Machine Learning and Knowledge Discovery in Databases. Cham: Springer Nature Switzerland